

Ingesting Data

Samuel Rowe adapted from Mitchell (2020)

2026-08-18

Contents

Overview	5
1 Ingesting Data	7
1.1 Getting our data	7
1.2 Reading Stata data	7
1.3 Reading Stata data with subsets	9
1.4 Importing Excel files	20
1.5 Importing SAS, SPSS, dbase files	22
1.6 Importing Raw Data files	24
2 Exercises	35
2.1 Importing dta files	35
2.2 Importing csv files	35
2.3 Importing Excel files	36
2.4 Importing SAS files	36
2.5 Import an SPSS file	36
3 Solutions	37
3.1 Importing dta files	37
3.2 Importing csv files	38
3.3 Importing Excel files	38
3.4 Importing SAS files	39
3.5 Import an SPSS file	40

Overview

We will cover importing data into Stata for analysis.

Overview:

1. Ingesting Data
2. Exercises

Chapter 1

Ingesting Data

Mitchell Chapter 2

Note when your working directory, I recommend using “/” instead of “” Stata will use both, and the backslash”” often runs into string issues.

1.1 Getting our data

We’ll get our data that we will use for the course.

```
pwd
*Set your working directory
cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/"

*Use:
net from https://www.stata-press.com/data/dmus2
net get dmus1
net get dmus2

*All commands:
net install dmus1
```

1.2 Reading Stata data

We use the *use* command to read Stata data. Use the *clear* option to clear the data from memory so you can read the data file. Otherwise, you will get an error

We’ll add the *clear* option to clear our memory to provide an error

```
cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
use "dentists.dta", clear
list
```

```
/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell
```

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

We can read Stata data from websources. From Stata Press website:

```
use "https://www.stata-press.com/data/dmus2/dentists.dta", clear
list
```

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

From NBER website

```
use "https://data.nber.org/morg/annual/morg20.dta", clear
list lfsr94 stfips sex in f/10
```

	lfsr94	stfips	sex
1.	Employed-At Work	AL	2
2.	Employed-At Work	AL	1
3.	Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	1
4.	Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	2
5.	Other-Not In Labor Force	AL	2

6.		Disabled-Not In Labor Force	AL	1	
7.		Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	1	
8.		Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	2	
9.		Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	2	
10.		Retired-Not In Labor Force	AL	1	

+-----+

1.3 Reading Stata data with subsets

Subsetting can be a helpful method to read in extremely large data sets, such as American Community Survey (ACS) public use file. We can subset by variables, observations, or both.

1.3.1 Subsetting by columns (variables)

You can read in a subset of Stata data by columns. This can be helpful when you have a large dataset but only need a few columns of data. However, you need to know the variable names. We will need to have a data dictionary in order to do this. The January CPS data dictionary can be found on Census's website. https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/datasets/2025/basic/2025_Basic_CPS_Public_Use_Record_Layout_plus_IO_Code_list.txt

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/CPS/"
use gestfips pemlr pternwa using "smalljul25pub.dta", clear
list in 1/3
```

		gestfips	pemlr	pternwa	

1.		1	.	.	
2.		1	5	-1	
3.		1	6	-1	

+-----+

If it is a large dataset, I don't recommend using list by itself. Use in $1/N$

1.3.2 Subsetting by rows (observations)

You can read in a subset of data by rows. In my opinion, this is a better method to subset than by columns. You are able to see the entire dataset. You can use a qualifiers *if* or *in*

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/CPS/"
use "smalljul25pub.dta" if gestfip == 24 & prtage == 30, clear
list in 1/10
```

```
1. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puic
   | 17011 | 7 | 7 | 2025 | 24 | 5 | 3 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty
   | 49 | 1 | 6 | 2 | 40 | 2 | 2 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peio1cd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2
   | 12 | -1 | 1 | 6380 | 4 | -1 | 6 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernhri
   | 23 | -1 | 17 | -1 | 1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1cd | hrhhid2
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 99149562 | -1 | 5510 | 9.401e+
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+

2. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puic
   | 17011 | 6 | 7 | 2025 | 24 | 5 | 2 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty
   | 51 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 39 | 2 | 4 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peio1cd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2
   | 44 | 8 | 1 | 770 | 4 | -1 | 3 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernhri
   | 4 | -1 | 20 | -1 | 2 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1cd | hrhhid2
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 48285071 | -1 | 7315 | 4.700e+
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+

3. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puic
   | 17012 | 8 | 7 | 2025 | 24 | 5 | 1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty
   | 41 | 1 | 6 | 2 | 42 | 2 | 2 |
   +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peio1cd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2
```

	40	-1	1	7280	4	-1	9	-1	
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peernlab	pre
	36	-1	17	-1	1	2	-1	2	
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhhid	ptwk	
	2	-1	-1	113138434	183000	5120	3.411e+14	0	

4.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puiodp1	puio
	19011	3	7	2025	24	5	4	-1	-1	
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prpertyp	prtag	
	49	1	6	2	39	2	1	2	3	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolcd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjind2	prmjc	
	32	-1	1	770	4	-1	3	-1		
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peernlab	pre	
	4	-1	22	-1	1	-1	-1	-1		
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhhid	ptwk		
	2	-1	-1	44333596	-1	9130	9.007e+14	0		

5.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puiodp1	puio
	19011	2	7	2025	24	5	1	-1	1	
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prpertyp	prtag	
	40	1	1	2	39	2	1	2	3	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolcd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjind2	prmjc	
	50	-1	1	170	4	-1	1	-1		
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peernlab	pre	
	1	-1	18	-1	1	-1	-1	-1		
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhhid	ptwk		
	2	-1	-1	31435370	-1	6050	9.450e+14	0		

6.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puiodp1	puio
	17011	5	7	2025	24	5	1	-1	-1	

	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
	41	1	6	1	45	2	4	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolicd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	40	-1	1	7980	4	-1	10	
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	42	-1	10	-1	1	-1	-1	
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	1	1	1	75007444	-1	3010	4.260e+	
7.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis
	19011	3	7	2025	24	5	2	1
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
	58	1	6	2	39	2	2	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolicd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	-1	-1	6	-1	-1	-1	-1	
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	2	-1	-1	106522944	-1	-1	6.604e+	
8.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis
	17011	6	7	2025	24	5	1	-1
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
	40	1	6	2	43	2	1	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolicd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	43	-1	1	6481	4	-1	7	
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	25	-1	16	-1	1	-1	-1	
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	2	-1	-1	34698967	-1	4850	4.223e+	

```

+-----+
+-----+
9. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
   | 19011 | 3 | 7 | 2025 | 24 | 5 | 1 | -1 | 1 |
+-----+
| perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | 41 | 1 | 6 | 1 | 43 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
+-----+
| pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmj
   | 50 | -1 | 1 | 7071 | 4 | -1 | 8 | -1 |
+-----+
| prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | pre
   | 34 | -1 | 2 | -1 | 1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
+-----+
| pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd | hrhhid | ptwk
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 50143408 | -1 | 800 | 1.913e+14 | 0 |
+-----+

+-----+
+-----+
10. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
    | 17011 | 5 | 7 | 2025 | 24 | 5 | 1 | -1 | -1 |
+-----+
| perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | 40 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 44 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
+-----+
| pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmj
   | 5 | -1 | 1 | 7460 | 5 | -1 | 9 | -1 |
+-----+
| prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | pre
   | 36 | -1 | 3 | -1 | 1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
+-----+
| pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd | hrhhid | ptwk
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 87833706 | -1 | 1006 | 2.911e+14 | 0 |
+-----+

```

```

quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/CPS/"
use "smalljul25pub.dta" in 1/10, clear
list

```

```

1. | hrhhid2 | hrmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
   | 17011 | 8 | 7 | 2025 | 1 | 6 | . | . | . |
+-----+
| perrp | pesex | peparitl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | . | . | . | . | . | . | . | . |

```

	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolcd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	.	.	.	.	.	.	1.617e+	
2.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis
	17011	8	7	2025	1	6	1	-1
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
	40	2	1	2	43	2	1	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolcd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	-1	-1	5	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	2	-1	-1	18467177	-1	-1	1.090e+	
3.	hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis
	17011	8	7	2025	1	6	2	1
	perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
	42	1	1	2	43	1	1	
	pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peiolcd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
	-1	-1	6	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1
	prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1
	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh	
	2	-1	-1	27264237	-1	-1	1.090e+	

```

4. | hrhhid2 | hrmmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
   | 17011 | 8 | 7 | 2025 | 1 | 6 | 1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | pemaritl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | 40 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 43 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 6
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmjc
   | -1 | -1 | 5 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | pre
   | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd | hrhhid | ptwk
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 24488360 | -1 | -1 | 6.101e+14 | 0
   +-----+-----+-----+

5. | hrhhid2 | hrmmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
   | 17011 | 8 | 7 | 2025 | 1 | 6 | 2 | -1 | 1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | pemaritl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | 42 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 39 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 6
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmjc
   | 4 | -1 | 1 | 7390 | 4 | -1 | 9 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | pre
   | 36 | -1 | 2 | -1 | 1 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd | hrhhid | ptwk
   | 2 | -1 | -1 | 18946917 | 8800 | 710 | 6.101e+14 | 0
   +-----+-----+-----+

6. | hrhhid2 | hrmmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
   | 17011 | 7 | 7 | 2025 | 1 | 6 | 1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | perrp | pesex | pemaritl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
   | 41 | 2 | 3 | 2 | 36 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 6
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmjc
   | -1 | -1 | 5 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+
   | prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | pre
   | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 | -1 |
   +-----+-----+-----+

```

	pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh
	2	-1	-1	20570322	-1	-1	9.101e+

7.

hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puic
17011	8	7	2025	1	6	.	.	.

perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peio1icd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh
.	.	.	.	.	.	4.524e+

8.

hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puic
17011	8	7	2025	1	6	.	.	.

perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peio1icd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

prdtind1	prdtind2	prdtocc1	prdtocc2	prsjmj	peernhry	peernhro	peern
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.

pecert1	pecert2	pecert3	pwcmpwgt	pternwa	ptio1ocd	hrhh
.	.	.	.	.	.	1.101e+

9.

hrhhid2	hrmis	hrmonth	hryear4	gestfips	gediv	pulineno	pudis	puic
17011	8	7	2025	1	6	1	-1	.

perrp	pesex	pemaritl	pehspnon	peeduca	peafever	ptdtrace	prperty
40	2	1	2	44	2	1	.

pehract1	pehract2	pemlr	peio1icd	peio1cow	peio2cow	prmjind1	prmjin
.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.


```

|      -1 |      -1 |      5 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | prerelg
|      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd |      hrhhid | ptwkw
|       2 |      -1 |      -1 | 19775533 |      -1 |      -1 | 5.314e+14 |      0
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
10. | hrhhid2 | hrmmis | hrmonth | hryear4 | gestfips | gediv | pulineno | pudis | puiodp1 | puio
| 17011 |      8 |      7 | 2025 |      1 |      6 |      2 |      -1 |      -1 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| perrp | pesex | pamaritl | pehspon | peeduca | peafever | ptdtrace | prperty | prtag
|    42 |      1 |      1 |      2 |    43 |      2 |      1 |      2 |      6
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| pehract1 | pehract2 | pemlr | peiolcd | peio1cow | peio2cow | prmjind1 | prmjind2 | prmj
|      -1 |      -1 |      5 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| prdtind1 | prdtind2 | prdtocc1 | prdtocc2 | prsjmj | peernhry | peernhro | peernlab | prerelg
|      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |      -1 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| pecert1 | pecert2 | pecert3 | pwcmpwgt | pternwa | ptio1ocd |      hrhhid | ptwkw
|       2 |      -1 |      -1 | 24488360 |      -1 |      -1 | 5.314e+14 |      0
|-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+

```

Subsetting by row and columns

```

quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/CPS/"
use gestfips pemlr pternwa prerelg using "smalljul25pub.dta" if gestfip == 24 & prerelg==1, clear
list in 60/69

```

```

| gestfips | pemlr | prerelg | pternwa |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+
60. |      24 |      1 |      1 | 132000 |
61. |      24 |      1 |      1 |  84000 |
62. |      24 |      1 |      1 | 108000 |
63. |      24 |      1 |      1 |  80000 |
64. |      24 |      1 |      1 | 163000 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+
65. |      24 |      1 |      1 | 170000 |
66. |      24 |      1 |      1 |  70000 |
67. |      24 |      1 |      1 |  54000 |
68. |      24 |      1 |      1 | 252000 |
69. |      24 |      1 |      1 |  60000 |
|-----+-----+-----+-----+

```

1.3.3 System data

There are data sets that are included in Stata and use the *sysuse* command.

```
sysuse auto, clear
list make price mpg rep78 foreign, sep(5)
```

(1978 automobile data)

	make	price	mpg	rep78	foreign
1.	AMC Concord	4,099	22	3	Domestic
2.	AMC Pacer	4,749	17	3	Domestic
3.	AMC Spirit	3,799	22	.	Domestic
4.	Buick Century	4,816	20	3	Domestic
5.	Buick Electra	7,827	15	4	Domestic
6.	Buick LeSabre	5,788	18	3	Domestic
7.	Buick Opel	4,453	26	.	Domestic
8.	Buick Regal	5,189	20	3	Domestic
9.	Buick Riviera	10,372	16	3	Domestic
10.	Buick Skylark	4,082	19	3	Domestic
11.	Cad. Deville	11,385	14	3	Domestic
12.	Cad. Eldorado	14,500	14	2	Domestic
13.	Cad. Seville	15,906	21	3	Domestic
14.	Chev. Chevette	3,299	29	3	Domestic
15.	Chev. Impala	5,705	16	4	Domestic
16.	Chev. Malibu	4,504	22	3	Domestic
17.	Chev. Monte Carlo	5,104	22	2	Domestic
18.	Chev. Monza	3,667	24	2	Domestic
19.	Chev. Nova	3,955	19	3	Domestic
20.	Dodge Colt	3,984	30	5	Domestic
21.	Dodge Diplomat	4,010	18	2	Domestic
22.	Dodge Magnum	5,886	16	2	Domestic
23.	Dodge St. Regis	6,342	17	2	Domestic
24.	Ford Fiesta	4,389	28	4	Domestic
25.	Ford Mustang	4,187	21	3	Domestic
26.	Linc. Continental	11,497	12	3	Domestic
27.	Linc. Mark V	13,594	12	3	Domestic
28.	Linc. Versailles	13,466	14	3	Domestic

29.	Merc. Bobcat	3,829	22	4	Domestic	
30.	Merc. Cougar	5,379	14	4	Domestic	

31.	Merc. Marquis	6,165	15	3	Domestic	
32.	Merc. Monarch	4,516	18	3	Domestic	
33.	Merc. XR-7	6,303	14	4	Domestic	
34.	Merc. Zephyr	3,291	20	3	Domestic	
35.	Olds 98	8,814	21	4	Domestic	

36.	Olds Cutl Supr	5,172	19	3	Domestic	
37.	Olds Cutlass	4,733	19	3	Domestic	
38.	Olds Delta 88	4,890	18	4	Domestic	
39.	Olds Omega	4,181	19	3	Domestic	
40.	Olds Starfire	4,195	24	1	Domestic	

41.	Olds Toronado	10,371	16	3	Domestic	
42.	Plym. Arrow	4,647	28	3	Domestic	
43.	Plym. Champ	4,425	34	5	Domestic	
44.	Plym. Horizon	4,482	25	3	Domestic	
45.	Plym. Sapporo	6,486	26	.	Domestic	

46.	Plym. Volare	4,060	18	2	Domestic	
47.	Pont. Catalina	5,798	18	4	Domestic	
48.	Pont. Firebird	4,934	18	1	Domestic	
49.	Pont. Grand Prix	5,222	19	3	Domestic	
50.	Pont. Le Mans	4,723	19	3	Domestic	

51.	Pont. Phoenix	4,424	19	.	Domestic	
52.	Pont. Sunbird	4,172	24	2	Domestic	
53.	Audi 5000	9,690	17	5	Foreign	
54.	Audi Fox	6,295	23	3	Foreign	
55.	BMW 320i	9,735	25	4	Foreign	

56.	Datsun 200	6,229	23	4	Foreign	
57.	Datsun 210	4,589	35	5	Foreign	
58.	Datsun 510	5,079	24	4	Foreign	
59.	Datsun 810	8,129	21	4	Foreign	
60.	Fiat Strada	4,296	21	3	Foreign	

61.	Honda Accord	5,799	25	5	Foreign	
62.	Honda Civic	4,499	28	4	Foreign	
63.	Mazda GLC	3,995	30	4	Foreign	
64.	Peugeot 604	12,990	14	.	Foreign	
65.	Renault Le Car	3,895	26	3	Foreign	

66.	Subaru	3,798	35	5	Foreign	

67.	Toyota Celica	5,899	18	5	Foreign	
68.	Toyota Corolla	3,748	31	5	Foreign	
69.	Toyota Corona	5,719	18	5	Foreign	
70.	VW Dasher	7,140	23	4	Foreign	

71.	VW Diesel	5,397	41	5	Foreign	
72.	VW Rabbit	4,697	25	4	Foreign	
73.	VW Scirocco	6,850	25	4	Foreign	
74.	Volvo 260	11,995	17	5	Foreign	
	+-----+					

You can use Stata files that are available, but didn't ship with Stata and they use the *webuse* command

```
webuse fullauto, clear
list make price mpg rep78 foreign in 1/5
```

(Automobile models)

		make	price	mpg	rep78	foreign	

1.		AMC	4099	22	Average	Domestic	
2.		AMC	4749	17	Average	Domestic	
3.		AMC	3799	22	.	Domestic	
4.		Audi	6295	23	Average	Foreign	
5.		Audi	9690	17	Excellent	Foreign	

1.4 Importing Excel files

Many times you will need to grab data from a website and these data may be in an Excel format such as ".xls" or ".xlsx". Our main command is *import excel*. We need to specify the *firstrow* option if we want the headers as variable names. Be careful if the headers are numerics, such as years, in the firstrow. This will throw an error and we'll need to rename them in Excel before importing these files. For example, 2015 becomes y2015.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
import excel using "dentists.xls", firstrow clear
list
```

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

We need to take caution of the sheet names of the excel files we are importing. If you don't pay attention you may import the wrong sheet.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
import excel using "dentists2.xls", firstrow clear
list

import excel using "dentists2.xls", firstrow clear sheet("dentists")
list
```

(2 vars, 4 obs)

	name	years
1.	I. Sue Yoo	3
2.	A. Dewey	8
3.	B. Cheetem	11
4.	C. Howe	21

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

1.5 Importing SAS, SPSS, dbase files

In my opinion, importing files from other statistical packages is a pain. If you are using another statistical software packages like R, SAS, Python, or heaven-forbid SPSS, then export the data from those software package as CSV files. CSV files are fairly universal. There maybe some labeling issues, but if labels are not a concern then use CSV file formats.

Luckily, SAS data files are becoming less common. Even the Census Bureau has seen the light and provides their data in a csv format.

1.5.1 Importing .sas7bdat

Import sas is our main command to import SAS from version 7 or higher.

```
import sas "dentists.sas7bdat", clear
list
```

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

1.5.2 Importing SAS XPORT Version 5

```
import sasxport5 "dentists.xpt", clear
list
```

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

1.5.3 Importing SAS XPORT Version 8

```
import sasxport8 "dentists.xpt", clear
list
```

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

1.5.4 Importing SPSS files

We can also import SPSS files with later versions of Stata. SPSS also has labels similar to Stata

```
import spss "dentlab.sav", clear
list
```

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	part time	recommend
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	full time	recommend
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	full time	recommend
4.	Ruth Canaale	22.00	full time	recommend
5.	Mike Avity	8.50	part time	do not recommend

1.5.5 Importing dBase files

For me, it is unavailable in Stata 14, but if you have Stata 16 or higher you can use this command.

```
import dbase "dentlab.dbf", clear
list
```

(4 vars, 5 obs)

	NAME	YEARS	FULLTIME	RECOM
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22.00	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.50	0	0

1.6 Importing Raw Data files

We use the *import delimited* command to read in csv, txt, dat, etc. files.

1.6.1 Import Delimited

Importing csv files will likely be more common than other types of files so far with the exception of Stata and Excel files. *Note:* there are other types of delimited files, but comma-delimited are the most common. Other types of delimiters include “tab”, “space”, or “|” delimited.

CSV file If you read the manual you’ll noticed that “,” and “^” are the default delimiters Using “,” delimiter:

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists.csv", clear
list

quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/CPS/"
import delimited using "jul25pub.csv", clear
list gestfips pemlr pternwa in 1/10
```

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
--	------	-------	----------	-------

1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(393 vars, 122,252 obs)

	gestfips	pemlr	pternwa
1.	1	.	.
2.	1	5	-1
3.	1	6	-1
4.	1	5	-1
5.	1	1	8800
6.	1	5	-1
7.	1	.	.
8.	1	.	.
9.	1	5	-1
10.	1	5	-1

CSV files may come in .txt files or .csv files using “,” delimiter

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists1.txt", clear
list
```

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

There may be “tab”-delimited files that use “`\t`” delimiter

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists2.txt", clear
list
```

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

This will produce the same results as above since “`\t`” is a default

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists2.txt", clear delimiters("\t")
list
```

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

If we set the delimiter to “`:`”, we can import a “`:`”-delimited file

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists4.txt", clear delimiters(":")
list
```

```
(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-2)
(4 vars, 5 obs)
```

	v1	v2	v3	v4
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

We can subset columns and rows with `import delimited`, which can be helpful for large files. Variable names will be defaulted for the first few rows, so when we use `rowrange(1:3)` this will only include 2 rows of data.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists2.txt", clear rowrange(1:3)
list
```

```
(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 2 obs)
```

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1

Import delimited from the web

```
import delimited using "https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/datasets/2023/basic/jun23pub"
pwd
save "jun23pub.dta", replace
```

1.6.2 Import delimited with subset of rows

You can use the `rowrange` option to subset large dataset. For example, the NPPEs admin data is over 10 GB. If we want to inspect the data, we can just use `rowrange`. Another example would be the American Community Survey Public Use File.

```
cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Data/NPPES/"
import delimited using npidata_pfile_20050523-20241208.csv, varnames(1) rowrange(1:10)
```

1.6.3 Import space-separated files

Sometimes files have space-delimited files (which is a bad idea when strings are involved). `Dentists5.txt` is an example of such a file. We can use the `infile` command to import these data, but we need to specify that the name variable is a string at least 17 characters wide.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
infile str17 name years full rec using "dentists5.txt", clear
list
```

(5 observations read)

	name	years	full	rec
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

Infile does not read in variable names in the first row.

We can also use `import delimited` with `delimiters(" ")`

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell"
import delimited using "dentists6.txt", delimiters(" ") clear
list
```

(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(4 vars, 5 obs)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1

4.		Ruth Canaale	22	1	1	
5.		Mike Avity	8.5	0	0	
+-----+						

1.6.4 Importing fixed-column files

Unfortunately, fixed-column files are more common than I prefer. They are a pain, since you need to specify each column length. I have found this with files with a “.dat” file extension.

We can use the *infix* command to read in fixed-column files. Let’s look at our fixed-column width files.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
type "dentists7.txt"
```

```
Y. Don Uflossmore 7.2501
Olive Tu'Drill 10.2511
Isaac O'Yerbreath32.7511
Ruth Canaale 22.0011
Mike Avity 8.5000
```

Our name variable is between 1 and 17, years are between 18 and 22. Our fulltime and recommend binaries are only length of 1 with 23 and 24.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
infix str name 1-17 years 18-22 fulltime 23 recom 24 using "dentists7.txt", clear
list
```

(5 observations read)

+-----+						
		name	years	fulltime	recom	
+-----+						
1.		Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1	
2.		Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1	
3.		Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1	
4.		Ruth Canaale	22	1	1	
5.		Mike Avity	8.5	0	0	
+-----+						

This is a real pain, but luckily Stata has dictionary files to help if one of these files are available. They have a .dct file extension. We already have a fixed-column dictionary with dentists1.dct and we can use it to open a fixed-column width file dentists7.txt

Let's look at our dictionary file.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
type "dentists1.dct"
```

```
infix dictionary {
  str name 1-17 years 18-22 fulltime 23 recom 24
}
```

Let's look at our fixed-column width file

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
type "dentists7.txt"
```

```
Y. Don Uflossmore 7.2501
Olive Tu'Drill    10.2511
Isaac O'Yerbreath 32.7511
Ruth Canaale      22.0011
Mike Avity        8.5000
```

Let's use the two together to import the data file

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
infix using "dentists1.dct", using(dentists7.txt) clear
list
```

```
infix dictionary {
  str name 1-17 years 18-22 fulltime 23 recom 24
}
(5 observations read)
```

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

We can combine infile command with a dictionary file.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
type "dentists3.dct"
```

```
infile dictionary using dentists7.txt {
    str17 name      %17s  "Name of dentist"
        years      %5f   "Years in practice"
        fulltime    %1f   "Full time?"
        recom       %1f   "Recommend Quaddent?"
}
```

Notice that the first line of the dictionary file is `infile dictionary using dentists7.txt` and then the column widths

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
infile using "dentists3.dct", clear
list
```

```
infile dictionary using dentists7.txt {
    str17 name      %17s  "Name of dentist"
        years      %5f   "Years in practice"
        fulltime    %1f   "Full time?"
        recom       %1f   "Recommend Quaddent?"
}
```

(5 observations read)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1
4.	Ruth Canaale	22	1	1
5.	Mike Avity	8.5	0	0

Dictionary .dct files are very helpful when they are available with fixed-column width files.

1.6.5 Subsetting fixed-column width files

We can use the “in” qualifier to subset the number of rows to import with either *infix* or *infile*.

```
quietly cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 645/Data/Mitchell/"
infix str name 1-17 years 18-22 fulltime 23 recom 24 using "dentists7.txt" in 1/3, clear
list

infix using "dentists1.dct" in 1/3, using(dentists7.txt) clear
list
```

(3 observations read)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1

```
infix dictionary {
  str name 1-17 years 18-22 fulltime 23 recom 24
}
```

(3 observations read)

	name	years	fulltime	recom
1.	Y. Don Uflossmore	7.25	0	1
2.	Olive Tu'Drill	10.25	1	1
3.	Isaac O'Yerbreath	32.75	1	1

1.6.6 2.8 Common errors when reading and importing files

Tip: Don't forget to clear your data. Either the line before or add it as an option , clear

Error 1 If you do not clear your data with the use command, then you will get the message “No; dataset in memory has changed since last saved” - Use *clear* in the line before ingesting the data, or use *clear* as an option.

Error 2 If you do not clear your data with the import, infix, or infile commands, then you will get the message: “You must start with an empty dataset”

1.6.7 Entering data directly into Stata Data Editor

My opinion: Please do not do this. If you need to manually enter data, I don't recommend manually entering data into STATA. I recommend using a spreadsheet, then import the spreadsheet.

If for some reason you don't have access to Excel or a spreadsheet application like OSX Numbers or Google Sheets, then read pages 43-50.

Chapter 2

Exercises

2.1 Importing dta files

Steps:

1. Go to NBER Current Population Survey (CPS) Merged Outgoing Rotation Group: <https://data.nber.org/morg/annual/>
2. Download and ingest the 2024 data
3. Use the *use* command to ingest the CPS data
4. Use the *list* command to find the State and County of the 200th observation.
5. What is the County and State of the 200th observation
6. Hint: Search for County FIPS code (e.g.: <https://fipsdecoder.com/county-fips-codes>)

2.2 Importing csv files

Steps:

1. Go to the Census Bureau's Current Population Survey home page
2. Download the July 2026 csv file
3. Use the *import delimited* command to ingest the July 2026 CPS file
4. What is the sex (psex) and labor force status (pemplr) of the 50th observation?
5. Use the CPS data dictionary: https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/datasets/2026/basic/2026_Basic_CPS_Public_Use_Record_Layout_plus_IO_Code_list.txt

2.3 Importing Excel files

Steps:

1. Go to St. Louis Federal Reserve Board FRED site for the unemployment rate: <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/UNRATE/>
2. Download the excel file “UNRATE.xlsx”
3. Import the excel file with the *import excel* command.
4. List the unemployment and date variables
5. What is the unemployment rate for May 2023?

2.4 Importing SAS files

Steps:

1. Download the NBER MEPS Panel 24 Longitudinal Data File <https://data.nber.org/meps/h225/h225.sas7bdat>
2. Import the Sas file into Stata
3. List the Person ID (DUPERSID, Year of Birth (DOBY), and Death Status during 2019-2020 (DIED) for the first 10 observations
4. Codebook: https://meps.ahrq.gov/mepsweb/data_stats/download_data/pufs/h225/h225cb.pdf
5. Did any one of the first 10 observations die during 2019-2020 panel?

2.5 Import an SPSS file

Steps:

1. Download the following file from Stata: <https://www.stata.com/sampledatabook/autosav>
2. Use the import command to ingest an SPSS file
3. List the first 10 observations’ make, price, and miles per gallon
4. What is the Miles per Gallon for the second observation?

The second observation has receives 17 miles per gallon.

Chapter 3

Solutions

Here are the solutions to the exercises

3.1 Importing dta files

Steps:

1. Go to NBER Current Population Survey (CPS) Merged Outgoing Rotation Group: <https://data.nber.org/morg/annual/>
2. Download and ingest the 2024 data
3. Use the *use* command to ingest the CPS data
4. Use the *list* command to find the State and County of the 200th observation.
5. What is the County and State of the 200th observation
6. Hint: Search for County FIPS code (e.g.: <https://fipsdecoder.com/county-fips-codes>)

```
use https://data.nber.org/morg/annual/morg24.dta, clear
list stfips county in 200
```

```
      | stfips   county |
      |-----|
200. |      AL      97 |
      +-----+
```

The 200th observation lives in Mobile County, Alabama.

3.2 Importing csv files

Steps:

1. Go to the Census Bureau's Current Population Survey home page
2. Download the July 2026 csv file
3. Use the *import delimited* command to ingest the July 2026 CPS file
4. What is the sex (pesex) and labor force status (pemlr) of the 50th observation?
5. Use the CPS data dictionary: https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/datasets/2026/basic/2026_Basic_CPS_Public_Use_Record_Layout_plus_IO_Code_list.txt

```
import delimited using "https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/cps/datasets/2026/basic/2026_Basic_CPS_Public_Use_Record_Layout_plus_IO_Code_list.txt"
list pesex pemlr in 50
```

```
(encoding automatically selected: ISO-8859-1)
(393 vars, 120,930 obs)
```

```

+-----+
| pesex  pemlr |
+-----+
50. |      1      4 |
+-----+
```

The 50th observation is male, who is unemployed - looking for employment

3.3 Importing Excel files

Steps:

1. Go to St. Louis Federal Reserve Board FRED site for the unemployment rate: <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/UNRATE/>
2. Download the excel file "UNRATE.xlsx"
3. Import the excel file with the *import excel* command.
4. List the unemployment and date variables
5. What is the unemployment rate for May 2023?

```
import excel using "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 643/Data/UNRATE.xlsx", sheet("Monthly") clear
list in 906
```

(2 vars, 944 obs)

```

+-----+
|           A           B |
+-----+
906. | 01may2023    3.6 |
+-----+

```

The unemployment rate in May 2023 was 3.6%

3.4 Importing SAS files

Steps:

1. Download the NBER MEPS Panel 24 Longitudinal Data File <https://data.nber.org/meps/h225/h225.sas7bdat>
2. Import the Sas file into Stata
3. List the Person ID (DUPERSID, Year of Birth (DOBY), and Death Status during 2019-2020 (DIED) for the first 10 observations
4. Codebook: https://meps.ahrq.gov/mepsweb/data_stats/download_data/pufs/h225/h225cb.pdf
5. Did any one of the first 10 observations die during 2019-2020 panel?

```
import sas using "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 643/Data/h225.sas7bdat", clear
list DUPERSID DOBY DIED in 1/10
```

(2,761 vars, 9,797 obs)

```

+-----+
|   DUPERSID   DOBY   DIED |
+-----+
1. | 2460002101   1945     0 |
2. | 2460004101   1941     0 |
3. | 2460004102   1941     0 |
4. | 2460005101   1994     0 |
5. | 2460005102   1993     0 |
+-----+
6. | 2460006101   1958     0 |
7. | 2460006102   1955     0 |
8. | 2460007101   1961     0 |
9. | 2460007102   1999     0 |
10. | 2460008101   1945     0 |
+-----+

```

None of the first 10 observations died during 2019-2020 panel.

3.5 Import an SPSS file

Steps:

1. Download the following file from Stata: <https://www.stata.com/sampleddata/auto.sav>
2. Use the import command to ingest an SPSS file
3. List the first 10 observations' make, price, and miles per gallon
4. What is the Miles per Gallon for the second observation?

```
import spss using "https://www.stata.com/sampleddata/auto.sav"
list make price mpg in 1/10
list mpg in 2
```

(12 vars, 74 obs)

```

+-----+
|          make    price    mpg |
+-----+
1. |   AMC Concord    4099    22 |
2. |   AMC Pacer     4749    17 |
3. |   AMC Spirit    3799    22 |
4. | Buick Century    4816    20 |
5. | Buick Electra    7827    15 |
+-----+
6. | Buick LeSabre   5788    18 |
7. |   Buick Opel     4453    26 |
8. |   Buick Regal    5189    20 |
9. | Buick Riviera   10372    16 |
10. | Buick Skylark    4082    19 |
+-----+

+-----+
| mpg |
+-----+
2. |  17 |
+-----+
```

The second observation has receives 17 miles per gallon.

Mitchell, N.M. (2020). *Data Management Using Stata: A Practical Handbook*. (2nd ed.). Stata Press.

UCLA Advanced Research Computing. (2025). *Stata Learning Modules*. Retrieved from <https://stats.oarc.ucla.edu/stata/modules/>

Note: Recommended resources UCLA OARC Stata resources: <https://stats.oarc.ucla.edu/stata/modules/>

I have used this source on numerous times. Even when you become proficient with Stata, UCLA's OARC Stata resources have been very helpful. If you just type *UCLA OARC Stata* in a search engine, then it will usually pop up.

Statalist is usually another good resource when trying to figure out what went wrong. If you ask a question on the listserve, you will likely be scolded by Nick Cox, or you will be told to "read the manual". However, if you just read what others have asked, you will often find useful information.